

WORKED EXAMPLE Jack Mo reads it aloud

Trade partner & crew board

THE UNTRAINED EYE vs THE RISK MANAGER'S EYE



Jack Mo reads the board — the budget line, the trade stack, the sub roster, the crew count.

To a passing eye this is just a tidy project dashboard - a budget line, a schedule, a roster of subs, a crew count. Everything is tracked, everything looks under control. A risk manager reads the same board and the tidiness disappears; they stop reading it as a status report and start reading it as a confession. They don't see a budget line; they watch the actual cost pull away from plan and climb past the general-conditions cap - the job is quietly bleeding money the longer it drags. They don't see a schedule; they see five trades stacked into one window, crews working on top of each other, every one slower for it. They walk the roster the way an auditor would: one sub's cash is amber - undercapitalized, one slow payment from trouble - and another is on site with no bond and no insurance, so any claim it triggers lands on you. Then they read the crew count against the plan and find the bars short every week - the skilled trades aren't in the market, so the work goes undermanned. The casual eye reads a board to feel reassured. The trained eye reads the same board to find where it is bleeding - money, schedule, a shaky partner, a thin crew - because none of it shows up on the building until it's too late to fix cheaply. The board never changed between those two readings. The eye did.

THIS SCENE FEEDS YOUR REGISTER
R10 · R14 · R18 · R22 · R26 — the five students dealt this scene.

The discipline under that read

The moves you run so you can see it too — then five register rows fall out of one glance.

- LOOK

read it like a P&L — budget line → schedule density → sub roster → crew count; don't stop at the first red.
- SPLIT

say what you SEE — facts only: The actual-cost line has pulled above plan and is climbing past the general-conditions budget cap, Five trades are stacked into a single window - crews working on top of each other, One subcontractor's cash is flagged amber - undercapitalized and one slow payment from trouble.
- NOTICE

circle the cues: The budget actual climbing above plan and past the general-conditions cap; Five trades stacked into one congested window on the schedule; The roster flags - one sub's cash amber, another with no bond or insurance — and the missing There is no contingency or schedule float showing on the board - nothing in reserve to absorb a sub that stumbles or a crew that shows up short.
- ASK → PROJECT

what releases it, who's in the path, what happens next — and in which phase.

NAME · five rows, born from one glance (cause → event → consequence)

- 1

Financial

Because general conditions keep running while congested trades work slower, the GC's general-conditions budget drains faster than the work earns it back, leading to a cost overrun that surfaces late in the job.
Owner: Project Manager · Trigger: GC cost-to-complete outpacing percent-complete on the monthly cost report
- 2

Financial

Because a subcontractor is undercapitalized, it may run short of cash mid-job and slow down or default, leading to the work behind it stopping until it is replaced.
- 3

Contractual

Because a sub is on site without the required bond or insurance, an uncovered claim may appear if something goes wrong, leading to claims exposure the GC has to carry.
- 4

Schedule

Because the skilled trades are short in this market, crews may show up undermanned, leading to delayed work and quality strain as fewer hands rush to keep pace.
- 5

Cost

Because retainage holds back cash from already-thin subs, a partner's cash flow may tighten further, leading to slow pay down the chain and a work slowdown - a risk you read off the board yourself.

READING MOVE · bank this card
“Read the board like a P&L, not a status report - trace each line in turn (budget burn, schedule density, sub financial health, crew count vs plan) and flag every place it is bleeding.”

SUCCESS CARD · check the read against these six

- ☐ a real, visible cue

☐ cause is a site condition

☐ a future event

☐ consequence on cost/time/quality/safety
- ☐ owner + early-warning trigger

☐ (M4) P and I each defended

P × I? Not yet — Module 2 IDENTIFIES; Module 4 ASSESSES. These rows seed register rows R10 · R14 · R18 · R22 · R26.